IE Staff member:	

PROJECT BRIEF – INDUSTRY SOLUTIONS PROJECT

ORGANISATION DETAILS	
Organisation name: Mount Alexander Sustainability Group	
Address: 30 Templeton Street, Castlemaine	
Email address: development@masg.org.au	**Telephone: 0489151682**
ABN:	**Website:** www.masg.org.au
Organisational Background (*What is the key business/activity of the host organisation*): Mount Alexander Sustainability Group (MASG) is the peak sustainability organisation for the Mount Alexander Shire, delivering education, research, advocacy, and endorsement for shire wide sustainability and clean energy initiatives. MASG was established in 2006 by a passionate group of locals who wanted coordinated action on climate change and to support the Mount Alexander Shire Community to work towards a sustainable future. **Our 4 key focus areas are:** - **Waste Reduction** - **Renewable Energy** - **Energy Efficiency** - **Agriculture**	
Number of employees in organisation (*check box*): Less than 20 ☒ Between 21 and 100 ☐ Between 101 and 500 ☐ More than 500 ☐	**How many years have the organisation been operating?** (*check box*): Less than 1 ☐ Between 1 and 5 ☐ Between 5 and 10 ☐ Between 10 and 20 ☒ More than 20 ☐
La Trobe WBL overarching agreement already in place (*please select*): ☐ Yes ☐ No ☒ Unsure	
Does the organisation have Public & Products Liability Insurance to a minimum of $AU10million? Yes ☒ No ☐ Unsure ☐	

Industry key contact	Industry key contact details	Has the key contact graduated from a course at La Trobe?
Name: Kerrily Jennings Title: Projects & Engagement Coordinator	Email: development@masg.org.au Phone number: 0489151682	☐ Yes ☒ No

La Trobe to complete this section	
Academic Supervisor details	***Academic Supervisor contact details***

Name: *Title:*	*Email:* *Phone number:*

PROJECT BRIEF DETAILS	
Semester/Year: ☒ Semester 1 2026 - 2 March to 29 May ☐ Semester 2 2026 – 13 July to 9 October	
Please add a project title which best describes the type of work the project will involve and will be appealing to students. **Project Title: Developing the Strength, Viability and Connectedness of MASG.**	
Problem statement/background: *This section provides a detailed description of the issue or challenge that the project aims to address, including relevant context and background information.*	1. How to make volunteering in sustainability / regeneration community projects accessible, enticing and viewed as a worthy investment of time/energy to people aged between 16 and 30? 2. Financial sustainability is an ongoing limitation of MASG, constantly dependent on securing external funding and membership fees. We'd like to explore social enterprise options for MASG with potential to develop an income stream to support our activities, whilst also engaging with community, in alignment with our values, mission and focus areas. 3. In our modern world, communication is diverse in platforms, mediums, messaging and audience. We seek to better understand how to reach multi-generational audiences, towards increasing diverse engagement with our organisation, projects, events and happenings. What could be the best strategies to achieve this?
Project Scope: *This outlines the specific tasks, deliverables, and activities that will be included in the project, as well as any exclusions, constraints, and assumptions.*	Key Research Questions • What factors influence youth perceptions of volunteering in sustainability-related initiatives? • Which social enterprise opportunities best align with MASG's strengths, community context, and environmental goals? • How can digital, social, and creative communication strategies foster cross-generational engagement? Project Scope: 1. Environmental impact, sustainability, and ecological regeneration • Conduct research on best practices and sustainability initiatives implemented by comparable organisations.

	• Undertake benchmarking analysis to identify performance gaps and opportunities for improvement. • Perform a literature review of evidence-based community based sustainability environmental regeneration strategies and compile findings into a research report with actionable recommendations. 2. Market Analysis • Investigate viable social enterprise models aligned with MASG's mission and values. • Analyse and compare pricing and revenue structures across the sector. • Evaluate and report on financial sustainability strategies, focusing on long-term viability and scalability. 3. Technology and Innovation • Research and benchmark the technological tools and platforms used by peer and partner organisations. • Evaluate technology pricing models and assess cost-effectiveness. • Design an app layout (no prototype) that supports community engagement and education/engagement with sustainability and regenerative practice. • Assess the impact and effectiveness of existing and emerging technologies within the sector. 4. Marketing and Community Engagement • Develop marketing campaigns that communicate MASG's vision and achievements effectively. • Create community narratives and storytelling frameworks to inspire emotional connection and participation. • Strengthen branding and visual identity to enhance public recognition and trust. **All of these need to maintain a connection with MASG being a NFP, community guided-driven-led grassroots organisation, with a focus on us not just doing for community, but with community.
Project Objectives: *These are the specific, measurable goals that the project aims to achieve, providing clear direction and purpose for the project.*	Project objectives: • Benchmark and evaluate sustainability practices • Develop evidence-based recommendations • Assess financial and market viability • Enhance digital engagement • Strengthen organisational branding and outreach • Promote innovation and continuous improvement

Project Outcomes: *The end results or benefits that will be achieved once the project is completed - reflect on the desired impact and value delivered by the project.*	The successful completion of this project will result in actionable insights, innovative tools, and strategic frameworks that enhance MASG's capacity for sustainability leadership, financial sustainability, and community impact. The outcomes will provide a foundation for informed decision making, improved engagement, and long-term organisational growth.
Further information relevant to students:	
The Industry Solutions Project *The information in this Project Brief will be shared with students once consultancy teams are formed and at the commencement of the program. Industry partners will meet their student teams at the Induction Day and again at the Pitch Day. Full program details, including key dates, will be provided within 4–6 weeks. If you have any questions, please reach out to a member of the La Trobe Talent team: LaTrobeTalent@latrobe.edu.au*	